

TRANSFORMING ADULT EDUCATION



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This text was compiled on 06/15/2026

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

Modules

The following five instructional modules, Professional Communication, Time Management and Task Completion, Teamwork and Conflict Resolution, Self-Advocacy and Goal Setting, and Adaptability and Problem-Solving, collectively comprise the instructional toolkit developed from this study. The toolkit extends the research findings 5 by translating the principles of Universal Design for Learning (UDL) and Socially Just Disability Resources (SJDR) into practical, replicable lesson templates for use in inclusive adult and workforce-preparation settings.

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Thumbnail: Young people college students are laughing and talking to friendly professor who is standing in front of them, speaking and gesturing. Education, modern lifestyle and youth concept. (Unsplash License; [Vitaly Gariev](#) via [Unsplash](#))

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Toolkit Overview

Universal Design for Learning Lesson Planning Resources for Inclusive Workforce Education

Applied Framework Informed by Study Findings

The following five instructional modules, Professional Communication, Time Management and Task Completion, Teamwork and Conflict Resolution, Self-Advocacy and Goal Setting, and Adaptability and Problem-Solving, collectively comprise the instructional toolkit developed from this study. The toolkit extends the research findings 5 by translating the principles of Universal Design for Learning (UDL) and Socially Just Disability Resources (SJDR) into practical, replicable lesson templates for use in inclusive adult and workforce-preparation settings.

The toolkit contextualizes general essential skills of instruction and bridges the gap between course content and applied workforce readiness. It is designed to allow instructors to integrate these lessons into any course with minimal modification, providing ready-to-use, evidence-based activities that align academic instruction with real-world employability skills.

Each module operationalizes the study's central premise that equitable instruction requires proactive design. The templates demonstrate how UDL's three principles multiple means of engagement, representation, and expression can be integrated with SJDR to foster learner agency, persistence, and workplace readiness among adults with intellectual and developmental disabilities (IDD). Together, these modules illustrate how inclusive design and workforce alignment can be embedded systematically in instructional practice.

The toolkit is intended for use by faculty, counselors, and educational coaches across noncredit, credit, hybrid, and community-based programs.

Each module includes the following components:

- **Scenario-based learning activities** that reflect authentic workplace contexts and emphasize problem solving and emotional regulation.
- **Scaffolded instruction** that gradually releases responsibility to promote independence and confidence.
- **Multimodal instructional materials** designed for accessibility and cultural responsiveness.
- **Reflection and assessment tools** that support self-regulation, goal setting, and continuous improvement.
- **Faculty implementation notes** that highlight trauma-informed, culturally sustaining, and equity-centered practices.

While the modules may be implemented individually, they are designed to function as an integrated framework addressing core “transferable” employability skills: communication, organization, collaboration, self-advocacy, and adaptability. Collectively, the toolkit supports statewide goals for equitable workforce and economic development consistent with the California Community Colleges' *Vision 2030* framework (CCCCO, 2025). This appendix presents the toolkit as the applied outcome of the study, illustrating how research on UDL and SJDR can inform the design of equitable adult education and workforce programs. The following sections present complete lesson templates that faculty may adapt for local contexts while maintaining fidelity to the study's guiding principles and findings.

Appendices Overview

The following appendices provide applied tools, templates, and supporting materials that extend the findings of this study into practical use for faculty, counselors, and students in inclusive adult and workforce-preparation programs. Each appendix builds on the Universal Design for Learning (UDL) and Socially Just Disability Resources (SJDR) frameworks from study findings.

Appendix	Title	Primary Audience	Purpose / Description

Appendix	Title	Primary Audience	Purpose / Description
A	Faculty Implementation Guide	Faculty / Instructors	Introduces UDL and SJDR foundations; provides scaffolding, trauma-informed, and culturally responsive strategies for inclusive lesson design. Serves as a quick-reference orientation to the toolkit. Contains five complete instructional modules—Professional
B	Lesson Plan Templates(Modules)	Faculty / Instructors	Communication, Time Management and Task Completion, Teamwork and Conflict Resolution, Self-Advocacy and Goal Setting, and Adaptability and Problem-Solving—that demonstrate applied UDL design in workforce contexts.
C	Faculty Reflection and Fidelity Tools	Faculty / Administrators	Includes the Faculty Reflection Log and Program Fidelity Tracker used to document UDL-aligned instruction, learner engagement, and continuous improvement.
D	Student-Centered Tools	Students / Faculty	Provides goal-setting, reflection, and self-assessment worksheets that promote learner agency and connect classroom practice to workforce readiness.
E	Resource Repository: Lesson Template and Licensing Information	Faculty / Curriculum Designers	Offers an editable lesson-plan shell, Creative Commons attribution guidance, and notes for future adaptation to ensure sustainability and program alignment with Vision 2030 priorities.

Usage Note

Appendices A-E collectively form the *Toolkit for Inclusive Workforce Education*, the applied product of this dissertation. They are organized for direct implementation, adaptation, and continuous improvement in inclusive adult education and workforce programs.

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Appendix A - Faculty Implementation Guide

Purpose

This guide supports instructors in implementing *Universal Design for Learning (UDL)* and *Socially Just Disability Resources (SJDR)* within Career Development and College Preparation (CDCP) and College-to-Career (C2C) courses. It translates study findings recommendations into actionable teaching strategies that advance workforce readiness and equity.

Faculty may reference this guide when designing new modules or use it each term as a fidelity check for existing lessons.

Section 1. Foundations for Inclusive Teaching

UDL in Practice

UDL invites instructors to plan for learner variability from the outset rather than retrofit accommodations.

- Engagement: Present authentic, emotionally resonant workplace dilemmas to connect learning to relevance and belonging (Flanagan et al., 2022).
- Representation: Offer information through visuals, discussion, video, and text, using multimodal templates that model accessibility across media.
- Expression: Provide varied demonstration modes; oral, digital, or performance, to capture mastery.

Try This: When planning, ask “How will students *see*, *hear*, and *do* this skill in multiple ways?”

Andragogy and Adult Learning

To honor adult learners’ autonomy, instructors can integrate the following design habits (Knowles, 1984; Leif et al., 2023):

- Begin with a *problem to solve* rather than content to memorize.
- Leverage learners’ prior experience as expertise.
- Emphasize immediate workplace relevance.
- Allow flexibility for learners balancing work, study, and family obligations (Fensie, 2023).

UDL + SJDR Alignment

UDL anticipates barriers; SJDR affirms identity. Instructors can operationalize this alignment by designing lessons that anticipate barriers (UDL) while affirming learner identities and agency (SJDR).

Drawing on Yosso’s (2005) *community cultural wealth*, modules center learners’ lived experiences as assets.

For example, invite students to contribute workplace examples from their cultural or community contexts when introducing new skills.

Reflect: How do my examples reflect cultural and linguistic diversity? Whose experiences are missing?

Section 2. Designing Instruction

Scaffolding for Autonomy

Begin with high support (worked examples, sentence stems, checklists) and intentionally fade toward independence (Flanagan et al., 2022).

Table A Scaffolded Instruction Sequence: Faculty and Learner Roles

Stage	Faculty Role	Learner Role
Model	Demonstrate the task; think aloud.	Observe and note steps.
Guide	Offer prompts, templates, and feedback.	Practice using scaffolds.
Release	Remove supports gradually.	Apply skills independently.

Note

This table illustrates the gradual-release model (Model → Guide → Release) as applied in UDL-aligned instruction for adult learners.

Trauma-Informed and Culturally Responsive Strategies

Facilitators should begin each module by reviewing community agreements, affirming learner voice, and framing mistakes as opportunities for growth. These strategies reduce anxiety and promote a sense of belonging, which research shows improves persistence for adult learners with IDD.

- Establish psychological safety (“We learn by trying.”).
- Provide opt-out options for sensitive role-plays.
- Normalize reflection and repair over correction.
- Use culturally grounded examples of communication and teamwork (Westerlin and Folske-Starlin, 2024).

Tip

Incorporate storytelling from diverse mentors or alumni to illustrate workplace norms across cultures.

Dual-Mode Delivery

Modules are designed for delivery both in-person and online (dual-mode).

- In-person: emphasize tactile, peer-interactive tasks.
- Online: embed captioned video, discussion boards, and adaptive pacing.
- Hybrid: pair synchronous modeling with asynchronous reflection.

Accessibility Check

Confirm captioning, screen-reader compatibility (no emoticons), alt-text for visuals, and high-contrast color schemes.

Section 3. Implementation and Reflection

Faculty Reflection Checklist

Faculty may use the Reflection Checklist (Appendix D) at the end of each module to evaluate inclusion, learner engagement, and UDL fidelity.

Prompts include:

- How did learners demonstrate agency today?
- Which scaffolds supported the most engagement? Which should fade sooner?
- How did today’s activity promote learner choice and voice?
- Whose voices or experiences were centered or overlooked in today’s activity?

Communities of Practice

Instructors are encouraged to collaborate in professional learning communities to share adaptations, build consistency, and ensure equitable implementation across programs. Peer observation and co-design promote collective efficacy and reduce faculty isolation.

Section 4. Vision 2030 Alignment

In alignment with Vision 2030’s priorities of access, equity, and workforce mobility, this toolkit supports institutional goals by (CCCCO, 2025):

- Embedding stackable micro-credentials that validate transferable soft skills (e.g., *Effective Communicator*, *Adaptive Problem Solver*).
- Strengthening career mobility through equitable, flexible learning pathways.
- Encouraging lifelong learning via reflection and continuous improvement cycles. Faculty participation in these practices contributes to institutional metrics for equity, retention, and workforce preparation identified in Vision 2030 (CCCCO, 2025).

Visual Idea: Institutions may use a three-column table (Goal | Instructional Strategy | Faculty Action) to demonstrate alignment during program review.

Section 5. Continuous Improvement

Reflect and Refine:

- Which instructional strategies produced the strongest learner persistence? • How did I document UDL fidelity across modalities?
- What equity gaps remain visible, and what institutional supports could address them?

At the end of each term, schedule a 30-minute reflection using student feedback to adjust one activity for improved inclusion. UDL and SJDR are iterative frameworks; faculty are encouraged to revisit module design after each term, using outcome data and reflections to improve inclusion and effectiveness.

Optional Resources

- Quick-Start Checklist: *Top 10 Inclusive Teaching Moves* (one-page summary for easy reference).
- Evidence Collection Ideas: Collect learner reflections, micro-credential completions, or accessibility-audit notes to document impact.

Summary

This guide operationalizes inclusive pedagogy through concrete steps faculty can use immediately. It merges *theory* (UDL, SJDR, andragogy) with *practice* (lesson templates, reflection checklists, and faculty collaboration), ensuring that workforce readiness education for adult learners with IDD is equitable, scalable, and directly aligned with the recommendations presented in the dissertation study findings.

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Appendix A-1 - Self-Assessment for Universal Design for Learning and Inclusive Instruction

Purpose

This checklist supports instructors in reviewing each lesson or module for alignment with Universal Design for Learning (UDL), trauma-informed, and culturally responsive practices.

It can be completed before instruction (planning) and after delivery (reflection).

Section 1. Planning for Accessibility and Inclusion

Check each item that applies to your lesson design.

Table A1 UDL and Inclusive Instruction Self-Assessment

Planning Element		Notes / Examples
☐	Learning outcomes are written in plain, accessible language.	
☐	Activities address at least two modalities (e.g., visual + discussion).	
☐	Materials are captioned, include alt-text, and meet color-contrast standards.	
☐	Technology or files are keyboard-accessible and mobile-friendly.	
☐	Directions and expectations are posted in multiple formats (verbal + written).	
☐	Opportunities for learner choice are built into the activity.	
☐	Classroom agreements promote psychological safety and respect.	

Note

This checklist supports faculty reflection on UDL-aligned lesson design and inclusion practices.

Section 2. Scaffolding and Support

Table A2 Scaffolding and Support Checklist

Instructional Element		Notes / Examples
☐	Supports progress from <i>modeling</i> → <i>guided</i> → <i>independent</i> practice.	
☐	Learners are encouraged to reflect on their own progress.	
☐	Feedback emphasizes growth over perfection.	
☐	Supports fade gradually to build independence and confidence.	

Note

This table outlines key scaffolding principles for gradual release and reflective teaching.

Section 3. Reflection and Continuous Improvement

Use these prompts after delivery.

1. What aspects of the lesson best supported learner agency or autonomy?
2. Which scaffolds or materials were most effective?
3. What barriers did learners experience, and how can they be reduced next time?
4. How did the lesson affirm cultural and linguistic diversity?
5. What evidence (student feedback, work samples) will guide my next improvement?

Section 4. Summary

Overall alignment with UDL and inclusive practice:

☐ Strong ☐ Adequate ☐ Needs Revision

Instructor Signature: _____ Date: _____ **Use Notes**

- May be duplicated for each module in the Toolkit for Inclusive Workforce Education.
- Can be stored digitally as part of faculty reflection documentation or shared within professional-learning communities.

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Appendix B-1 - UDL Aligned Introduction to the Module

Professional Communication Module: Toolkit Lesson Template - UDL Aligned

Introduction to the Module

The Professional Communication module equips adult learners with intellectual and developmental disabilities (IDD) to build verbal, nonverbal, and digital communication skills that foster confidence and success in inclusive employment. Employers consistently identify clear communication, teamwork, and customer interaction as top workforce competencies (Williams et al., 2023). Yet adults with IDD may experience barriers such as processing delays, limited workplace communication experience, or anxiety during social exchanges (Burke et al., 2021).

This module integrates Universal Design for Learning (UDL) principles, Socially Just Disability Resources (SJDR), and andragogical scaffolding to create inclusive, culturally responsive opportunities for learners to practice professional communication in authentic workplace contexts. Designed for delivery both in-person and online (dual mode), the lesson embeds trauma-informed and growth-mindset strategies that normalize mistakes as opportunities for learning.

Approximate time: 90 minutes - adaptable for single or double class periods.

Learning Outcomes

(UDL Checkpoint: Clarify Learning Goals - CAST, 2024)

By the end of this module, learners will be able to:

- Identify three characteristics of effective professional communication (clarity, tone, active listening).
- Demonstrate communication strategies through structured role-play or digital simulation.
- Reflect on personal communication strengths and set one improvement goal for future workplace interactions.

Rationale: Communication proficiency is consistently ranked by employers as a leading factor in hiring and retention (Williams et al., 2023).

Scenario-Based Hook

(UDL Checkpoint: Recruit Interest + Connect to Relevance)

“You start a new job at a community center. On your first day, a coworker gives instructions quickly, and you’re not sure what they said. How do you respond?” Learners brainstorm possible responses individually, then discuss options in pairs or breakout rooms. Facilitators highlight respectful clarification techniques and model curiosity over correction.

Rationale: Scenario-based learning builds emotional connection and promotes transfer of communication skills to authentic workplace contexts (RTI International, 2024; Stadd et al., 2023).

Direct Instruction: Multiple Means of Representation

(UDL Checkpoint: Provide Options for Perception and Understanding)

Table B1 Professional Communication Resources

Format	Example Resource	UDL Justification
Video	Short clip contrasting effective vs. ineffective communication at work.	Supports visual + auditory comprehension (Melhem and Al-Zoubi, 2025).
Infographic	Visual chart showing the “Active Listening Loop” (listen → clarify → respond → confirm).	Aids memory and benefits visual learners and those with executive-function needs.
Text Handout	One-page guide on respectful tone, body language, and digital etiquette - available in accessible digital format (screen-reader friendly, alt-text for visuals).	Serves as a reference for multiple review opportunities.

Rationale: Multimodal delivery ensures accessibility and honors learner variability (Evmenova et al., 2024).

Scaffolded Activities

(UDL Checkpoint: Build Mastery + Gradually Release Responsibility)

Table B2 Professional Communication Scaffolded Activities Flow

Level	Activity	Supports / Timing
Model	Instructor demonstrates a short conversation showing active listening and clarifying questions.	Scripted example, cue cards, visual checklist (≈ 10 min).
Guide	Learners practice workplace dialogues in pairs using sentence starters and facilitator feedback.	Structured scripts, coaching, and visual cues (≈ 20 min).
Release	Learners independently role-play a new scenario or record a short digital interaction demonstrating communication strategies.	Optional scaffolds remain available (≈ 25 min).

Rationale: Structured fading of supports fosters autonomy and confidence in communication (Montgomery et al., 2024).

Student Reflection and Self-Advocacy

(UDL Checkpoint: Foster Self-Regulation)

Reflection prompts:

- “How did you ensure your message was clear?”
- “What was challenging about listening or clarifying today?”
- “Describe one workplace or volunteer situation where you can apply today’s communication strategy.”

Learners set one personal communication goal for use in future teamwork or customer interactions.

Rationale: Embedding reflection builds self-awareness and self-advocacy, enhancing job retention and persistence (Burke et al., 2021).

Assessment Options

(UDL Checkpoint: Multiple Means of Action and Expression)

Table B3 Professional Communication Assessments Options

Format	Description	Alignment
Performance Rubric	Instructor evaluates learners’ clarity, tone, and listening in role-play or digital submissions using a 3-point scale (<i>Developing / Proficient / Advanced</i>).	Benchmarked to workforce communication competencies (Williams et al., 2023).
Self Assessment Checklist	Learners rate their communication comfort, clarity, and listening skills.	Builds metacognitive awareness and self monitoring (King, 2024).
Peer Feedback	Peers provide constructive input on tone, collaboration, and listening.	Encourages collaborative reflection and adaptive communication.

Instructor Notes

Delivery Modes

- *In-Person:* Facilitate paired conversations, live demonstrations, and quick feedback circles.
- *Online:* Use breakout-room dialogues, discussion threads, or video submissions with captioned feedback. Ensure all videos are captioned and discussion prompts are compatible with screen-reader navigation.

Adaptations for Learners with ID/ASD/IDD

- Provide visual cue cards and sentence starters.
- Offer opt-out alternatives for public role-play.
- Begin each session with a co-created group agreement on respect and listening.

- Embed culturally responsive examples highlighting multilingual and community based communication norms (e.g., compare greetings or tone expectations in community-center vs. retail settings; Ojeda-Ramirez et al., 2024).

Rationale: Trauma-informed, culturally responsive scaffolds create psychological safety and promote equitable participation (Westerlin and Folske-Starlin, 2024).

Faculty Reflection Prompts

(Linked to Appendix D Reflection Checklist)

- How did learners demonstrate agency and voice today?
- Which scaffolds supported the most engagement?
- Whose voices or experiences were centered—or overlooked—in discussions?
- How did today’s activity advance equity, access, or workforce-mobility goals?

Before Teaching This Module – Visual Fidelity Checklist

- ☐ Captioning verified
- ☐ Visuals and alt-text ready
- ☐ Group agreement reviewed
- ☐ Scaffolds printed or uploaded

Cross-Lesson Transfer Prompt

“Which of these communication strategies might help you in the Time Management or Teamwork module?”

Encourages learners to recognize how soft skills connect across modules. **Faculty Professional Development Connection**

Instructors are encouraged to share one communication-scenario adaptation or facilitation tip in their Professional Learning Community (PLC) to promote cross program consistency and institutional learning (see Appendix A).

How to Use This Template

This module illustrates how to embed communication skill-building within UDL aligned, scaffolded instruction. The structure authentic scenarios, multimodal delivery, faded supports, and reflective assessments can be adapted across programs or used to design micro-credential pathways in *Professional Communication* or *Customer Service Skills*.

By operationalizing inclusive design, this module fulfills the recommendations of the study to integrate UDL + SJDR principles, trauma-informed strategies, and workforce competencies into scalable faculty practice consistent with Vision 2030 priorities (CCCCO, 2025).

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Appendix B-2 - UDL + SJDR Aligned

Time Management and Task Completion Module: Toolkit Lesson Template - UDL + SJDR Aligned

Introduction to the Module

The Time Management and Task Completion module supports adult learners with intellectual and developmental disabilities (IDD) in strengthening executive-functioning skills essential for competitive employment. Employers consistently cite organization, punctuality, and follow-through as key indicators of workplace readiness, ranking these alongside communication and teamwork in hiring decisions (Williams et al., 2023).

Learners with IDD, ASD, or other cognitive differences may experience barriers such as difficulty prioritizing, organizing schedules, or sustaining attention under pressure (Burke et al., 2021). This module integrates Universal Design for Learning (UDL), Socially Just Disability Resources (SJDR), and scaffolded instruction to teach practical, workplace-aligned time-management strategies. Lessons are designed for dual mode delivery (in-person and online) and embed trauma-informed, culturally responsive practices that reduce anxiety and promote agency.

Approximate time: 90 minutes - adaptable for single or double class periods. In alignment with Vision 2030 goals-access, equity, and workforce mobility-this module prepares learners for stackable micro-credentials in *Organization and Productivity* and reinforces employability across pathways (CCCCO, 2025).

Learning Outcomes

(UDL Checkpoint: Clarify Learning Goals - CAST, 2024)

By the end of this module, learners will be able to:

- Identify three strategies for organizing and completing workplace tasks.
- Apply scheduling and prioritization techniques using guided-practice tools.
- Reflect on personal time-management habits and set one goal for future employment scenarios.

Rationale: Employers rank time management and task completion among the top five soft skills influencing job retention and advancement (Williams et al., 2023).

Scenario-Based Hook

(UDL Checkpoint: Recruit Interest + Connect to Relevance)

“Imagine you start a new job at a busy office. Your supervisor gives you three tasks to finish by the end of the day. How do you decide which one to start first? How will you ensure you finish on time?”

Learners brainstorm in small groups or breakout rooms, sharing strategies for prioritization. Facilitators highlight varied approaches before moving into direct instruction.

Example: You have 15 minutes to plan your approach before the instructor checks in.

Rationale: Authentic workplace dilemmas increase motivation and help adult learners transfer skills from classroom to employment (RTI International, 2024; Stadd et al., 2023).

Direct Instruction: Multiple Means of Representation

(UDL Checkpoint: Provide Options for Perception and Understanding)

Table B4 Time Management and Task Completion Resources

Format	Example Resource	UDL Justification
Video	Short clip demonstrating effective vs. ineffective time-management practices at work.	Visual modeling supports comprehension and retention (Melhem and Al-Zoubi, 2025).

Format	Example Resource	UDL Justification
Text Checklist	One-page list of strategies (e.g., planners, reminders, breaking tasks into steps) - available in accessible digital format (screen reader friendly with alt-text for visuals).	Serves as a concrete reference and universal access tool.
Visual Organizer	Color-coded daily task template or digital calendar sample.	Supports executive functioning and visual learners (Triana-Vera and López-Vargas, 2025).
Hands-on Demo	Sorting and sequencing task cards to simulate prioritizing steps.	Adds kinesthetic engagement and supports tactile learners.

Rationale: Offering multimodal entry points ensures accessibility and honors learner variability (Evmenova et al., 2024).

Scaffolded Activities

(UDL Checkpoint: Build Mastery + Gradually Release Responsibility)

Table B5 Time Management and Task Completion Scaffolded Activities Flow

Level	Activity	Supports / Timing
Model	Instructor demonstrates prioritizing three workplace tasks using a visual organizer and think-aloud approach.	Templates, verbal cues (≈ 10 min).
Guide	Learners practice scheduling sample tasks with structured checklists and receive feedback.	Sentence starters + shared templates (≈ 20 min).
Release	Learners create their own daily schedule for a mock shift, selecting task priorities and timelines.	Optional scaffolds available (≈ 25 min).

Note

Use a visual timer or auditory cue to mark each stage shift.

Rationale: Systematically fading supports builds autonomy and executive function skills (Montgomery et al., 2024).

Student Reflection and Self-Advocacy

(UDL Checkpoint: Foster Self-Regulation)

Reflection prompts:

- “Which time-management strategy worked best for you today?”
- “What was challenging about planning or staying on schedule?”
- “Describe one workplace or volunteer situation where you can apply today’s strategy.”
- “What tools or supports help you stay on schedule, and how can you request them at work?”

Learners set a personal goal to practice time-management skills in future classes or jobs.

Rationale: Embedding reflection and self-advocacy promotes independence and persistence (Burke et al., 2021).

Assessment Options

(UDL Checkpoint: Multiple Means of Action and Expression)

Table B6 Time Management and Task Completion Assessment Options

Format	Description	Alignment
Performance Rubric	Instructor evaluates prioritization, scheduling, and task completion skills using a 3-point scale (<i>Developing</i> / <i>Proficient</i> / <i>Advanced</i>).	Benchmarked to workforce readiness metrics (Williams et al., 2023).

Format	Description	Alignment
Self-Assessment Checklist	Learners rate planning and follow-through abilities and identify growth areas.	Builds metacognitive awareness (King, 2024).
Peer Feedback	Learners exchange mock schedules and offer constructive suggestions on priorities and timelines.	Encourages collaboration and critical thinking.

Instructor Notes

Delivery Modes

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- *In-Person*: Use large-format planners, timing games, and visual scheduling boards.
- *Online*: Employ digital tools (e.g., Google Calendar, Trello) with captioned tutorials. Provide transcripts for all tutorial videos and ensure color-coded templates meet contrast-ratio guidelines (encourage the use of universal visual icons or emojis - only if your platform supports accessibility; provide a text alternative).

Adaptations for Learners with IDD / ASD

- Provide visual task organizers and color-coded templates.
- Offer guided practice with sentence starters to support planning language.
- Allow assistive technology (e.g., voice-to-text reminders or digital alerts).
- Integrate trauma-informed strategies—normalize small setbacks as learning opportunities and celebrate progress.
- Discuss how communal vs. individual time orientations affect teamwork and scheduling expectations (Ojeda-Ramirez et al., 2024).

Rationale: Embedding assistive and culturally responsive supports enhances equity and belonging (Westerlin and Folske-Starlin, 2024).

Faculty Reflection Prompts

(Linked to Appendix D Reflection Checklist)

- How did learners demonstrate agency in organizing their work?
- Which scaffolds were most helpful and which can fade next time?
- Whose experiences or time perspectives were centered or missing?
- How did today’s activity advance equity, access, or workforce-mobility goals?
- What minor change will you test next time to enhance inclusion or efficiency?

Before Teaching This Module - Visual Fidelity Checklist

- ☐ Captioning verified
- ☐ Digital organizer accessible with alt-text
- ☐ Group agreement reviewed
- ☐ Scaffolds and timers prepared

Cross-Module Transfer Prompt

“Which time-management strategies could also support you in the Teamwork or Adaptability module?”

Encourages learners to connect organization skills to collaboration and problem solving.

Faculty Professional Development Connection

Instructors are encouraged to share time-management templates, alternate scenarios (e.g., restaurant or retail settings), or digital-tool tips within their Professional Learning Community (PLC) to promote cross-program consistency and institutional scalability.

Optional Extension

Table B7 Time Management and Task Completion Optional Extension – Micro-Credential Alignment

Skill	Evidence of Mastery	Micro-Credential Tag
Prioritization	Completed task-sequencing chart	Efficient Planner
Scheduling	Accurate daily plan in mock shift	Workplace Organizer
	Follow-ThroughReflection + Peer Feedback on completed plan	Dependable Employee

How to Use This Template

This module models the integration of UDL-aligned instruction, SJDR principles, and andragogical scaffolding for adult learners with IDD. By combining realistic workplace scenarios, multimodal resources, kinesthetic activities, and reflective practice, faculty can deliver inclusive, workforce-aligned instruction that fulfills the recommendations of research findings and advances *Vision 2030* priorities for equitable access, success, and mobility (CCCCO, 2025).

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Appendix B-3 - UDL Aligned Introduction to the Module

Teamwork and Conflict Resolution Module: Toolkit Lesson Template - UDL Aligned Introduction to the Module

The Teamwork and Conflict Resolution module supports adult learners with intellectual and developmental disabilities (IDD) in building collaboration, empathy, and interpersonal communication skills essential for integrated employment. Employers consistently rate teamwork, adaptability, and relationship management among the most valued competencies (Williams et al., 2023).

This lesson is designed for courses where students practice interpersonal communication in applied workforce settings.

Learners with IDD or ASD may experience barriers such as differing communication styles, anxiety in group settings, or difficulty interpreting nonverbal cues (Burke et al., 2021). This module applies Universal Design for Learning (UDL), Socially Just Disability Resources (SJDR), and trauma-informed scaffolding to create psychologically safe, culturally responsive spaces for collaboration practice.

Approximate time: 90 minutes - adaptable for single or double class periods. In alignment with Vision 2030 priorities access, equity, and workforce mobility this module advances institutional goals for equitable teamwork instruction and micro credentials in *Collaboration and Conflict Resolution (CCCCO, 2025)*.

Learning Outcomes

(UDL Checkpoint: Clarify Learning Goals - CAST, 2024)

By the end of this module, learners will be able to:

- Describe three strategies for effective teamwork and respectful collaboration.
- Demonstrate conflict-resolution techniques through structured role-play and guided practice.
- Reflect on personal teamwork strengths and set one goal for future collaboration.

Rationale: Employers link teamwork and conflict-resolution competence to retention and advancement (Williams et al., 2023).

Scenario-Based Hook

(UDL Checkpoint: Recruit Interest + Connect to Relevance)

“You’re assigned to a team project at your new job. Two coworkers disagree about how to complete the task, and everyone looks to you for input. How would you handle the situation?”

Learners brainstorm possible responses individually, then discuss solutions in pairs or breakout rooms. Facilitators emphasize respectful listening, shared problem solving, and compromise.

Note

Use a group-agreement reminder before discussion to reinforce respect and turn taking.

You have 10 minutes to develop your response before teams share strategies.

Rationale: Authentic dilemmas strengthen relevance and promote emotional connection, increasing transfer to workplace contexts (RTI International, 2024; Stadd et al., 2023).

Direct Instruction: Multiple Means of Representation

(UDL Checkpoint: Provide Options for Perception and Understanding)

Table B8 Teamwork and Conflict Resolution Resources

Format	Example Resource	UDL Justification
Video	Short clip showing effective vs. ineffective team communication.	Visual + auditory modeling supports understanding (Melhem and Al-Zoubi, 2025).

Format	Example Resource	UDL Justification
Infographic	Step-by-step “Conflict Resolution Flow” diagram (Stop → Listen → Acknowledge → Collaborate).	Visual structure aids executive function planning.
Text Guide	Two-page handout on active listening and “I-Statement” techniques - screen reader friendly with alt-text.	Provides reference for repeated access.
Hands-On Demo	Learners sort color-coded cards labeled “escalating” vs. “de-escalating” phrases.	Adds tactile reinforcement.
Interactive Poll	Learners vote on best conflict-resolution responses; results discussed live.	Digital engagement supports online/hybrid learners.

Rationale: Multimodal inputs enhance engagement and equitable access (Evmenova et al., 2024).

Scaffolded Activities

(UDL Checkpoint: Build Mastery + Gradually Release Responsibility)

Table B9 Scaffolded Activities Flow Table

Level	Activity	Supports / Timing
Model	Instructor demonstrates a team conflict and models resolution using the flowchart.	Scripted example, cue cards (≈ 10 min).
Guide	Learners role-play scenarios in pairs or groups using sentence starters and facilitator feedback.	Structured scripts + coaching (≈ 20 min).
Release	Learners create their own teamwork scenario and demonstrate resolution strategies to class or in breakouts.	Optional supports available (≈ 25 min).

After the guided stage, pause for a one-minute debrief: “What helped your team communicate effectively?”

Note

Use a visual timer or auditory cue to signal each stage shift.

Rationale: Fading supports builds autonomy and confidence in collaboration (Montgomery et al., 2024).

Student Reflection and Self-Advocacy

(UDL Checkpoint: Foster Self-Regulation)

Prompts for journaling or discussion:

- “What role do you usually take when working in a team?”
- “How comfortable are you speaking up during a disagreement?”
- “Describe a time you helped resolve a conflict successfully.”
- “What strategies help you stay calm and focused when disagreement arises?”
- “What supports help you collaborate effectively, and how can you request them at work?”

Rationale: Reflection on roles, regulation, and supports strengthens self advocacy (Burke et al., 2021).

Assessment Options

(UDL Checkpoint: Multiple Means of Action and Expression)

Format	Description	Alignment

Format	Description	Alignment
Performance Rubric	Instructor evaluates learners' use of the Conflict-Resolution Flow and teamwork behaviors using a 3-point scale (<i>Developing / Proficient / Advanced</i>).	Benchmarked to workforce competencies (Williams et al., 2023).
Self-Assessment Checklist	Learners rate teamwork skills and identify growth goals.	Encourages metacognition (King, 2024).
Peer Feedback	Peers offer constructive comments on cooperation and tone.	Promotes empathy and perspective-taking.

Instructor Notes

Delivery Modes

- **In-Person:** Use team-building games, live role-plays, and small-group reflections.
- **Online:** Facilitate breakout-room dialogues and shared documents. Provide captioned videos and transcripts; ensure collaborative documents are keyboard navigable and use accessible color contrast.

Adaptations for Learners with IDD / ASD

- Supply visual communication cards and sentence frames.
- Offer opt-out choices for public performance.
- Begin each session with co-created group agreements on respect and confidentiality.
- Discuss how communal vs. individual time orientations or cultural norms influence team dynamics. Example: Compare direct vs. indirect communication styles in U.S. and collectivist workplaces (Ojeda-Ramirez et al., 2024).

Rationale: Culturally responsive and trauma-informed supports build belonging and reduce conflict-related stress (Westerlin and Folske-Starlin, 2024).

Faculty Reflection Prompts

(Linked to Appendix D Reflection Checklist)

- How did learners demonstrate agency and voice in team activities?
- Which supports helped groups collaborate most effectively?
- Whose perspectives were highlighted—or missing—in discussions?
- How did today's lesson advance equity, access, or workforce-mobility goals?
- What minor change will you test next time to improve inclusion or efficiency?
- How does this lesson contribute to program-level equity and retention goals?

Before Teaching This Module - Visual Fidelity Checklist

- ☐ Captioning verified
- ☐ Infographics include alt-text
- ☐ Group agreement reviewed
- ☐ Timers and role-play materials ready

Cross-Module Transfer Prompt

“Which teamwork or conflict-resolution strategies could also help you manage change in the Adaptability module?”

Encourages learners to connect collaboration to flexibility and problem-solving. **Faculty Professional Development Connection**

Instructors are encouraged to share adapted teamwork scenarios or role-play scripts in their Professional Learning Community (PLC) to build a repository of inclusive workplace simulations and document term-end adaptations for system-wide scaling.

Optional Extensions

Table B11 Teamwork and Conflict Resolution Optional Extensions

Resource	Purpose	Access Note
<i>Mini-Case Options</i>	Two short scenarios (Retail vs. Community Center) for learner choice → enhanced agency.	Available as editable handouts.
<i>Conflict Resolution Flowchart</i>	Downloadable image with alt-text for faculty reuse.	Embed in LMS or print.
<i>Team Roles Template</i>	Lists Facilitator, Recorder, Timekeeper roles to promote equitable participation.	Include as optional handout.

How to Use This Template

This module demonstrates how UDL and SJDR principles translate into practical teamwork instruction. Through authentic scenarios, multimodal delivery, and faded supports, it empowers faculty to teach collaboration as a core workforce competency. The design aligns with the recommendations outlined in research findings and supports *Vision 2030* priorities by embedding access, equity, and career mobility into instructional practice (CCCCO, 2025).

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Appendix B-4 - UDL Aligned Introduction to the Module

Self-Advocacy and Goal Setting Module: Toolkit Lesson Template - UDL Aligned Introduction to the Module

The Self-Advocacy and Goal Setting module empowers adult learners with intellectual and developmental disabilities (IDD) to communicate their needs, set achievable goals, and take ownership of learning and employment pathways. Self advocacy directly supports persistence, independence, and successful transitions to competitive employment (Burke et al., 2021; King, 2024).

This lesson is designed for noncredit and workforce preparation courses that help adult learners build the self-determination skills needed to transition into career technical education, certificate, or degree pathways.

This module may be delivered as a stand-alone workshop or embedded within a career-readiness sequence. Learners may face barriers such as reluctance to disclose needs, difficulty articulating goals, or limited prior experience with collaborative planning.

The module integrates Universal Design for Learning (UDL), Socially Just Disability Resources (SJDR), and the Self-Determined Learning Model of Instruction (SDLMI) to create inclusive, scaffolded opportunities for voice, choice, and agency. Lessons are trauma-informed and culturally responsive, affirming identity while reducing anxiety around disclosure and decision-making.

Approximate time: 90 minutes - adaptable for single or double class periods.

Aligned with Vision 2030 priorities - access, equity, and workforce mobility - this module contributes to micro-credentials in *Self-Management and Advocacy* and supports institutional metrics for student success and retention (CCCCO, 2025).

Learning Outcomes

(UDL Checkpoint: Clarify Learning Goals - CAST, 2024)

By the end of this module, learners will be able to:

- Define self-advocacy and identify at least two situations where it applies in school or work.
- Use a structured goal-setting framework (*Know → Plan → Speak Up*) to create a personal action plan.
- Communicate one support need or accommodation request respectfully and clearly.

Rationale: Explicit instruction in self-advocacy improves employment retention and quality of life for adults with IDD (Burke et al., 2021; Triana-Vera and López Vargas, 2025).

Scenario-Based Hook

(UDL Checkpoint: Recruit Interest + Connect to Relevance)

“You’ve been at your job for two weeks. Your supervisor changes your shift and forgets to update your transportation schedule. You’re not sure how to ask for help without upsetting anyone - what do you do?”

Learners brainstorm individually, then discuss options in small groups. Use a group-agreement reminder before sharing to reinforce safety and respect. Notice how your body feels before responding; take a breath before choosing your next step.

You have 10 minutes to plan your response before discussion.

Rationale: Realistic advocacy scenarios increase engagement and normalize help-seeking behaviors (RTI International, 2024).

Direct Instruction: Multiple Means of Representation

(UDL Checkpoint: Provide Options for Perception and Understanding)

Table B12 Self-Advocacy and Goal Setting Resources

Format	Example Resource	UDL Justification
Video	Short clip modeling self advocacy in a workplace conversation.	Combines visual + auditory cues to show tone and body language (Melhem and Al-Zoubi, 2025).
Infographic	“Three Steps to Self-Advocacy” chart (<i>Know → Plan → Speak Up</i>).	Visual sequencing supports memory and recall.

Format	Example Resource	UDL Justification
Text Handout	Goal-setting worksheet (SDLMI-adapted) - accessible PDF with alt-text.	Scaffolded prompts for independent planning.
Interactive Poll	Learners vote on appropriate advocacy responses; results discussed live.	Encourages digital participation and peer learning.
Role Card Demo	Tactile cards labeled <i>Challenge / Support / Goal</i> for sorting exercise.	Adds kinesthetic engagement.

Accessibility Reminder: Ensure all embedded videos include captions and transcripts.

Scaffolded Activities

UDL Checkpoint: Build Mastery + Gradually Release Responsibility

B13 Self-Advocacy and Goal Setting Scaffolded Activities Flow

Level	Activity	Supports / Timing
Model	Instructor models an accommodation-request dialogue using the “Know → Plan → Speak Up” steps.	Script + visual flowchart (≈ 10 min).
Guide	Learners practice goal-setting and advocacy scripts in pairs; instructor provides feedback.	Templates + cue cards (≈ 20 min).
Release	Learners record or present a short self-advocacy scenario describing a goal and support request.	Optional scaffolds remain available (≈ 25 min).

Learners can reference the flowchart during practice; goal = communicate a need using clear, respectful language.

Note

Use a visual timer or auditory cue to mark stage shifts.

Rationale: Scaffolded autonomy strengthens confidence and transfer (Montgomery et al., 2024).

Student Reflection and Goal Setting

(UDL Checkpoint: Foster Self-Regulation)

Prompts (for individual or group reflection - choose 2–3):

- “What situation makes it hardest for you to speak up?”
- “What strategies help you stay calm when requesting help?”
- “Who are your support people at school or work?”
- “What goal do you want to work on this month, and what is your first step?”
- “What resources or tools can you ask for to reach this goal?”

Rationale: Reflecting on supports and next steps strengthens persistence and self determination (Burke et al., 2021).

Assessment Options

(UDL Checkpoint: Multiple Means of Action and Expression)

Table B14 Self-Advocacy and Goal Setting Assessment Options

Format	Description	Alignment
Performance Rubric - Advocacy Dialogue and Goal Plan	Instructor evaluates clarity, tone, and <i>goal clarity</i> + <i>realistic action step</i> using 3-point scale (<i>Developing / Proficient / Advanced</i>).	Benchmarked to workplace communication competencies (Williams et al., 2023).

Format	Description	Alignment
Goal-Setting Worksheet	Learners complete SDLMI-based plan identifying goal, actions, and supports.	Builds planning and self monitoring skills.
Peer Feedback	Peers comment on confidence, tone, and specificity in advocacy examples.	Promotes empathy and perspective-taking.

Instructor Notes

Delivery Modes

- *In-Person:* Use printed worksheets, live demonstrations, and paired practice.
- *Online:* Use shared documents and captioned videos. Ensure files are keyboard navigable and meet color-contrast guidelines.

Remind learners that recordings are shared only with the instructor unless explicit consent is given.

Adaptations for Learners with IDD / ASD

- Provide visual scripts and advocacy flowcharts.
- Offer private or recorded practice options for learners with anxiety.
- Model “I-Statement” frames (“I need __ to __.”).
- Encourage multilingual learners to practice requests in both English and their home language if desired.
- Include cultural examples: compare direct vs. indirect communication in U.S. and collectivist workplaces (Ojeda-Ramirez et al., 2024).

Rationale: Culturally aware, trauma-informed instruction promotes psychological safety and equitable participation (Westerlin and Folske-Starlin, 2024).

Faculty Reflection Prompts

(Linked to Appendix D Reflection Checklist)

- How did learners demonstrate agency and voice today?
- Which supports most improved learner confidence and clarity?
- Whose experiences or communication styles were centered or missed?
- How did today’s activity advance equity, access, or workforce-mobility goals?
- What minor change will you test next time to improve inclusion or efficiency?
- What will you share with colleagues or your PLC from this session’s outcomes?

Before Teaching This Module - Visual Fidelity Checklist

- ☐ Captioning verified
- ☐ Infographics and worksheets include alt-text
- ☐ Group agreement reviewed
- ☐ Advocacy scripts and flowcharts prepared

Cross-Module Transfer Prompt

“Which self-advocacy skills can help you communicate your needs in the Teamwork or Adaptability modules?”

Faculty Professional Development Connection

Instructors are encouraged to share advocacy prompts or goal-tracking templates within their Professional Learning Community (PLC) and document adaptations for term end analysis to support institutional improvement cycles.

Optional Extensions

Table B15 Self -Advocacy and Goal Setting Optional Extensions

Resource	Purpose	Access Note

Resource	Purpose	Access Note
<i>Mini Goal-Review Follow-Up</i>	5-minute check-in next class to review goals → supports persistence and data collection.	Add to lesson plan optional section.
<i>Quick-Reference Graphic</i>	One-page “Know → Plan → Speak Up” poster with alt-text for LMS upload or classroom display.	Screen-reader friendly.
<i>Integration Table</i>	Links advocacy skills to Teamwork, Adaptability, and Time Management modules for portfolio reflection.	Embed in student toolkit.

How to Use This Template

This module operationalizes UDL, SJDR, and SDLMI principles through authentic, scaffolded self-advocacy practice. By embedding voice, choice, and reflection within real-world contexts, instructors help adult learners with IDD develop confidence, persistence, and independence.

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Appendix B-5 - Universal Design for Learning (UDL) Aligned

Adaptability and Problem-Solving Module Toolkit Lesson Template – Universal Design for Learning (UDL) Aligned

Introduction to the Module

The Adaptability and Problem-Solving module prepares adult learners with intellectual and developmental disabilities (IDD) to respond flexibly to change, manage setbacks, and apply creative solutions in the workplace. Employers consistently identify adaptability, critical thinking, and resilience as top predictors of long-term success and retention (Williams et al., 2023).

This module can be used within any career-readiness, workplace success, or life skills sequence. It is designed for noncredit and workforce preparation courses that help adult learners develop transferable soft skills for career technical education, certificate, or degree pathways. Learners may experience challenges adjusting to unexpected change, managing frustration, or identifying multiple solutions to a problem.

The module integrates Universal Design for Learning (UDL), Socially Just Disability Resources (SJDR), and trauma-informed practice to create psychologically safe spaces where learners explore flexibility through authentic, culturally relevant scenarios.

Approximate time: 90 minutes - adaptable for single or double class periods. Aligned with Vision 2030 priorities - access, equity, and workforce mobility - this module strengthens learners' employability while equipping faculty to embed equitable design in instruction across disciplines (CCCCO, 2025).



Learning Outcomes

(UDL Checkpoint: Clarify Learning Goals - CAST, 2024)

By the end of this module, learners will be able to:

- Describe at least two strategies for staying calm and focused when plans change.
- Demonstrate a structured, step-by-step approach to solving a workplace problem.
- Reflect on how adaptability supports teamwork, communication, and career growth.

Rationale: Adaptability and problem-solving are identified by employers as essential *durable skills* for modern careers (NACE, 2024).

Scenario-Based Hook

(UDL Checkpoint: Recruit Interest + Connect to Relevance)

“You arrive at work ready to begin your usual task. Your supervisor asks you to cover for a coworker who called out. The schedule changes, and you have to learn a new register system in ten minutes. What do you do first?”

Learners brainstorm individually, then share in groups.



Note

Use a group-agreement reminder emphasizing patience and mutual support during problem-solving.

Pause and take one calming breath before choosing your response. You have 10 minutes to plan and discuss before the debrief.

Rationale: Scenario-based activities connect emotional regulation with real world adaptability (RTI International, 2024).

Direct Instruction: Multiple Means of Representation

(UDL Checkpoint: Provide Options for Perception and Understanding)

Table B16 Adaptability and Problem-Solving Resources

Format	Example Resource	UDL Justification

Format	Example Resource	UDL Justification
Video	Short clip showing an employee calmly adapting to an unexpected task change.	Models composure and growth mindset (Melhem and Al-Zoubi, 2025).
Infographic	“Four Steps to Problem-Solving” (Identify → Plan → Try → Reflect).	Visualizes sequence and supports executive functioning.
Text Guide	Quick-reference checklist for staying calm and analyzing choices - accessible PDF with alt-text.	Encourages self-regulation and review.
Interactive Poll	Learners vote on best responses to a change scenario; results guide discussion.	Supports digital engagement and metacognition.
Interactive Brainstorm/Poll	Learners brainstorm solutions collaboratively online.	Promotes shared digital engagement and creativity.
Hands-On Demo	Puzzle or sorting activity representing real-time problem solving.	Adds kinesthetic practice and team interaction.

Accessibility Reminder: Ensure all embedded videos include captions and transcripts. **Rationale:** Multimodal materials meet diverse learning needs and promote transferable understanding (Evmenova et al., 2024).

Scaffolded Activities

(UDL Checkpoint: Build Mastery + Gradually Release Responsibility)

Table B17 Adaptability and Problem-Solving Scaffolded Activities Flow

Level	Activity	Supports / Timing
Model	Instructor demonstrates structured problem-solving with a simple workplace challenge.	Think-aloud, visual chart (≈ 10 min).
Guide	Learners collaborate to solve a mock workplace problem (e.g., missing supplies, schedule conflict).	Sentence starters, timer, visual planner (≈ 20 min).
Release	Learners create their own problem scenario and present solution steps orally or digitally.	Optional scaffolds available (≈ 25 min).

Goal: Learners can describe the *four problem-solving steps* using their own example.

After the guided stage, pause for a one-minute debrief: “What helped you adapt and stay focused?”

Note

Use a visual timer or auditory cue to signal stage changes.

Rationale: Gradual release builds resilience and transfer of adaptive skills (Montgomery et al., 2024).

Student Reflection and Self-Advocacy

(UDL Checkpoint: Foster Self-Regulation)

Reflection prompts (choose 2–3):

- “How do you feel when plans change?”
- “What helps you regain focus after a setback?”
- “Describe a problem you solved by trying something new.”
- “What strategies can you use to stay calm in future changes at work or school?”
- “Who can support you when a task feels overwhelming?”
- **“How might adaptability help you advance or change roles at work?”**

Rationale: Reflection on emotional responses and supports builds self-awareness and agency (Burke et al., 2021).

Assessment Options

(UDL Checkpoint: Multiple Means of Action and Expression)

Table B18 Assessment Options Table

Format	Description	Alignment
Performance Rubric – Adaptability and Problem-Solving	Instructor evaluates learners’ problem solving process, <i>composure under change</i> , and adaptability using a 3-point scale (<i>Developing / Proficient / Advanced</i>).	Benchmarked to employer-valued competencies (Williams et al., 2023).
Self-Assessment Checklist	Learners rate how effectively they identified problems and adapted strategies.	Encourages metacognitive reflection (King, 2024).
Peer Feedback	Peers offer constructive observations on team adaptability and communication.	Reinforces empathy and perspective-taking.

Instructor Notes

Delivery Modes

- *In-Person:* Facilitate hands-on challenges (e.g., building a tower with limited materials).
- *Online:* Use digital puzzles or shared documents to simulate change under time constraints. Ensure captioning, keyboard navigation, and color-contrast compliance.

Ensure any digital games or simulations include keyboard-navigation and text alternatives.

Adaptations for Learners with IDD / ASD

- Provide visual checklists and flexibility scripts (“If X changes, I can try Y”).
- Offer opt-out choices for time-pressured tasks to reduce stress.
- Model growth-mindset language (“I can learn this with practice”).
- Discuss cultural attitudes toward adaptability - for example, collectivist workplaces may value group consensus over individual initiative.
- Discuss how age or hierarchy may influence adaptability expectations in different workplaces.

Rationale: Culturally aware instruction builds psychological safety and equitable participation (Westerlin and Folske-Starlin, 2024).

Faculty Reflection Prompts

(Linked to Appendix D Reflection Checklist)

- How did learners demonstrate flexibility and agency today?
- Which scaffolds most supported learners in responding to change?
- Whose voices or experiences were centered or overlooked?
- How did today’s activity advance equity, access, or workforce-mobility goals?
- What minor change will you test next time to improve inclusion or efficiency?
- How does this lesson contribute to program-level equity and retention goals?
- What evidence (student reflections or outcomes) can inform next-term improvements?

Before Teaching This Module – Universal Design Checklist

- ☐ Captioning verified
- ☐ Infographics and handouts include alt-text
- ☐ Group agreement reviewed
- ☐ Materials for problem-solving activity ready

Quick-Start Lesson Overview

Sequence: Scenario → Direct Instruction → Practice → Reflection → Assessment

Objective: Learners apply a four-step process to adapt to change and solve workplace problems.

Cross-Module Transfer Prompt

“How can adaptability help you communicate more effectively or stay on track with time management?”

Encourages learners to connect adaptability to previous modules and holistic workforce skills.

Faculty Professional Development Connection

Instructors are encouraged to share adaptability scenarios or digital tools within their Professional Learning Community (PLC) and document adaptations to support scaling and institutional learning.

Optional Extensions

Table B19 Adaptability and Problem-Solving Optional Extensions

Resource	Purpose	Access Note
<i>Mini-Scenario Choice</i>	Learners choose between two workplace challenges (e.g., restaurant rush hour vs. schedule change).	Editable handouts.
<i>Problem-Solving Flowchart</i>	Downloadable UDL-aligned graphic with alt-text (“Four Steps to Problem-Solving”).	Screen-reader friendly.
<i>Resilience Tracker</i>	Weekly reflection template for students to monitor how they adapt to change.	Printable or fillable form.
<i>Resilience Integration Journal</i>	Ongoing journal students update after each module to show growth over time.	Added to portfolio section.

How to Use This Template

This module models the integration of UDL, SJDR, and trauma-informed principles for teaching adaptability and problem-solving. Through authentic scenarios, multimodal activities, and reflective practice, it helps faculty operationalize equity and resilience as workforce competencies

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Appendix B-6 - "What Does Feeling Safe Mean?"

Universal Check-In: "What Does Feeling Safe Mean?"

Purpose

This universal check-in promotes emotional safety and trust within inclusive classrooms. It helps learners name feelings, set boundaries, and build community before engaging in workforce or communication skill practice.

Context of Use

May be used:

- At the start of a new module (to establish community norms).
- After challenging discussions or teamwork activities (to restore balance).
- During term transitions or reflection weeks.

Duration: 10–20 minutes (in-person or online)

Learning Outcomes

(UDL Checkpoint: Clarify Learning Goals CAST, 2024)

Learners will:

- Define in their own words what "feeling safe" means.
- Identify at least one behavior that shows respect for personal boundaries.
- Choose a communication mode that supports comfort and autonomy.

Universal Design Integration

Table B20 Universal Check-In Scaffolded Instructions Flow

Design Element	Example	Purpose
Multiple Means of Engagement	Learners connect the concept of safety to their lived experiences.	Builds relevance and belonging.
Multiple Means of Representation	Visual quote, icons, written prompts.	Supports comprehension and access.
Multiple Means of Expression	Writing, drawing, audio, icons selection.	Honors communication diversity.
SJDR Principle	Safety is co-created, not granted; learners define it for themselves.	Shifts power toward learner agency.

Facilitation Steps

1. **Read or display the quote:** "Feeling safe means being able to say what I need—even if I need help using the words."
2. **Ask guiding questions:**
 - "What does feeling safe mean to you?"
 - "How do you know when someone respects your boundaries?"
3. **Offer response choices:**
 - Type or write a few sentences.
 - Draw or use emoji to show how you feel.
 - Record a short audio or video message.
4. **Optional share-out:** Invite volunteers to share; emphasize that privacy is respected.
5. **Debrief:** Highlight collective themes - listening, respect, voice.

Scaffolding and Fading

Table B21 Universal Check-In Scaffolded and Fading Flow

Stage	Instructor Role	Learner Role
Model	Demonstrate how to answer using “I feel safe when ...”	Observe example.
Guide	Provide sentence starters and emojis.	Respond using supports.
Release	Remove prompts gradually; invite open reflection.	Express ideas independently.

Trauma-Informed and Culturally Responsive Practice

- Emphasize consent and opt-out choices.
- Allow general, non-personal examples.
- Discuss cultural differences in expressing comfort or trust.
- Validate all responses equally, there is no “wrong” way to feel safe.

Reflection and Assessment

- Full credit for participation/effort.
- Faculty reflection prompts (link to Appendix D):
 - *Did learners appear comfortable engaging?*
 - *How might this check-in reveal needs for classroom adjustment?* ◦ *How did this activity model safety for future workplace discussions?*

Adaptation Across Modules

Table B22 Universal Check-In Adaptation Across Modules

Module	Possible Integration
Professional Communication	Use before role-plays to establish respectful listening norms.
Teamwork and Conflict Resolution	Use after group activities to process collaboration feelings.
Self-Advocacy and Goal Setting	Frame it as “Advocating for what helps me feel safe.”
Adaptability and Problem Solving	Connect safety to staying calm in uncertain situations.

Summary

“**What Does Feeling Safe Mean?**” functions as a universal, trauma-informed reflection adaptable across lessons. This activity reinforces psychological safety as a foundational workforce competency linked to communication, teamwork, and self management-core to Vision 2030’s priorities and beyond of *access, equity, and mobility*. It models UDL + SJDR design, strengthens classroom trust, and prepares learners for equitable participation in workforce and academic environments (CCCCO, 2025).

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Appendix C - Ongoing Reflection for Inclusive and UDL-Aligned Instruction

Faculty Reflection Log: Ongoing Reflection for Inclusive and Universal Design for Learning (UDL)-Aligned Instruction

Purpose

This reflection log provides faculty with a simple, repeatable structure for documenting teaching practices, learner engagement, and ongoing improvement across modules or terms. It aligns with Universal Design for Learning (UDL) and equity centered instruction to encourage consistent, mindful reflection. The log values reflection as a growth practice rather than an evaluation tool.

Instructions

Complete this form after each class session, module, or instructional cycle. Use brief notes or bullet points. The goal is insight, not length.

Faculty may type, dictate, or handwrite notes; use any format that supports your own accessibility and reflection style.

Respond to any sections relevant to your session; not all need to be completed every time.

Reflection Prompts

Date: _____ **Module / Lesson:** _____ **Learner Engagement**

- How did learners participate or demonstrate curiosity today?
- What strategies promoted the most engagement?
- What signals (verbal, behavioral, or digital) showed connection?

Accessibility and Inclusion

- Were materials or activities accessible to all students?
- Were any accessibility features (captions, alt-text, translations) especially effective?
- Did any barriers emerge (technology, timing, format)?

Agency and Independence

- How did learners exercise choice or autonomy?
- Which scaffolds can be reduced or adapted next time?

Cultural and Linguistic Responsiveness

- How were diverse experiences or languages represented in discussion or examples?
- How did I acknowledge or invite community or cultural knowledge into the lesson?
- What adjustments might better affirm student identity?

Trauma-Informed Practice

- How did you establish safety or predictability in today's lesson?
- What signals showed that learners felt comfortable contributing?

Evidence and Next Steps

- What evidence (student comments, work samples, feedback) supports your observations?
- What one improvement will you test in your next session?
- How might you share this insight with colleagues or integrate it into program planning?

Summary Rating (Optional)

Table C1 Faculty Reflection Summary Rating Categories

Category	Strong	Adequate	Revision/ Adaptation Needed
Engagement and Participation	☐	☐	☐
Accessibility and Inclusion	☐	☐	☐

Category	Strong	Adequate	Revision/ Adaptation Needed
Scaffolding and Independence	☐	☐	☐
Cultural Responsiveness	☐	☐	☐
Trauma-Informed Approach	☐	☐	☐

Faculty Signature: _____ **Date:** _____ **Notes for Use:**

- May be used weekly or per module to support professional reflection and accreditation documentation.
- Entries can be compiled to demonstrate reflective teaching for professional review or grant documentation.
- Faculty are encouraged to share anonymized insights with program teams or professional-learning communities to strengthen inclusive practices.

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Appendix C-1 - Tracking Use of Toolkit Modules and UDL-Aligned Practices

Program Fidelity Tracker: Tracking Use of Toolkit Modules and Universal Design for Learning (UDL)-Aligned Practices

Purpose

This tracker helps faculty document which modules from the *Toolkit for Inclusive Workforce Education* were implemented, the inclusive strategies used, and brief reflections on outcomes. It serves as a record of practice for program review, professional learning, or grant reporting.

It can also help identify which inclusive strategies are most effective across contexts.

Instructions

Complete one line per class session, module, or instructional week.

Use brief notes or keywords; detailed reflections may be captured in the *Faculty Reflection Log*.

Columns may be customized to match local reporting or accreditation needs. *The table may be completed digitally using keyboard-accessible fields or printed for handwritten notes.*

Implementation Record

Table C1 Faculty Reflection Summary Rating Categories

Date	Module / Lesson Title	Format (In Person / Online / Hybrid)	Primary Skill / Focus	UDL / Inclusive Strategies Used	Evidence Learner Engagement	of Next Step / Adaptation	Initials

(Add or duplicate rows as needed.)

Quick Fidelity Self-Check (Mark all that apply)

- ☐ Learning outcomes posted and reviewed with learners.
- ☐ Multiple means of engagement, representation, and expression evident. ☐ Scaffolding followed model → guided → independent sequence.
- ☐ Accessibility supports (captions, alt-text, translations) verified.
- ☐ Reflection or debrief activity completed with learners.
- ☐ Learner feedback gathered informally (discussion, poll, reflection). **Summary**

Overall Fidelity This Term: ☐ Strong ☐ Adequate ☐ Needs Revision / Adaptation

Instructor Signature: _____ **Date:** _____ **Next review date or cycle:** _____

Use Notes:

- The tracker may be kept digitally or printed for department documentation.
- Summarized data can inform professional-learning goals or program-accreditation evidence.
- Consistent use supports alignment with *Vision 2030* priorities for equitable, data informed instruction (CCCCO, 2025).

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Appendix D - Templates for Goal Setting, Reflection, and Self- Assessment

Student-Centered Tools: Templates for Goal Setting, Reflection, and Self Assessment

Purpose

These student-centered tools promote self-awareness, goal setting, and reflection on workplace and academic skills. Each template supports learner agency and self regulation while reinforcing the soft skills embedded in the *Toolkit for Inclusive Workforce Education*.

They can be used independently, with a peer or coach, or as part of any module activity.

How to Introduce and Use These Tools

Faculty can introduce these student-centered tools at the start or end of any module to help learners connect soft-skill instruction to personal goals and workplace readiness. Each tool aligns with a specific competency area in the *Toolkit for Inclusive Workforce Education*:

- **Tool D-1 (Goal-Setting Worksheet):** complements the *Self-Advocacy and Goal Setting* module by guiding learners to define and track personal or employment goals.
- **Tool D-2 (Weekly Reflection Sheet):** reinforces *Time Management* and *Adaptability* modules through regular self-check-ins on progress and persistence.
- **Tool D-3 (Soft-Skills Self-Assessment):** connects to all modules by encouraging self-evaluation across communication, teamwork, and professionalism.
- **Tool D-4 (Visual Decision Organizer):** complements *Adaptability* and *Problem Solving* modules by modeling step-by-step reasoning.

Tool D-1. Personal Goal-Setting Worksheet

(Aligned with the Self-Determined Learning Model of Instruction - SDLMI)

Purpose

To help learners set and track meaningful goals for personal, academic, or employment growth.

Instructions: Complete one row for each goal. Keep responses short and specific. Learners can complete these independently, with a peer, or during coaching or reflection time.

Table D1 Learner Goal Setting Worksheet

What do I want to achieve?	Why is it important to me?	What steps will I take?	Who can help me?	How will I know I reached it?	Target Date	Progress Check (✓ or note)

Reflection Prompt:

- What did I learn about myself while working toward this goal?
- How might this goal connect to my future job or learning plans?

Tool D-2. Weekly Reflection Sheet

(To promote ongoing self-awareness and self-regulation)

Table D2 Weekly Learner Reflection Sheet

Question	My Reflection / Notes

Question	My Reflection / Notes
What went well this week?	
What challenges did I face?	
How did I solve or manage a problem?	
What skills did I practice (communication, teamwork, time management, etc.)?	
How did I feel about my learning this week?	
What is one thing I will try differently next time?	

Optional Faculty Prompt: Encourage students to share one insight during class or a check-in discussion.

Tool D-3. Soft-Skills Self-Assessment

(Adaptable for midterm or final reflection)

Rate yourself for each area:

1 = I am still learning 2 = I am improving 3 = I am confident

Table D3 Soft Skills Self-Assessment

Skill Area	1	2	3	Example or Evidence	Peer or Instructor Feedback (optional)
Communication	☐	☐	☐		
Teamwork	☐	☐	☐		
Time Management	☐	☐	☐		
Adaptability	☐	☐	☐		
Self-Advocacy	☐	☐	☐		
Professionalism	☐	☐	☐		

Reflection Questions:

- Which skill improved the most this term?
- Which one would I like to strengthen next?
- What support or strategy would help me continue growing?

Tool D-4. Visual Decision Organizer (Optional)

(Supports executive functioning, self-awareness, and problem-solving)

You can use words, symbols, or pictures - whatever helps you think.

Table D4 Visual Decision Organizer

Step	Question	Example Response
1. Identify the problem	What is happening?	"I'm having trouble finishing assignments on time."
2. Explore options	What could I try?	"Ask for help, plan smaller tasks, set a timer."
3. Choose a solution	Which one seems best?	"Plan smaller tasks."
4. Test and reflect	What worked? What didn't?	"The timer helped! I'll keep using it."

Alternative Formats: Learners may draw, use icons/emojis, or type bullet points depending on accessibility needs.

Notes for Use:

Instructors may select one tool per week, embed them in discussion or coaching sessions, or compile completed pages into a Workforce Readiness Portfolio for program documentation.

Using these tools regularly fosters learner autonomy, self-regulation, and reflection, core outcomes of UDL-aligned, equity-centered instruction.

- Tools may be completed digitally or printed for classroom use.
- Faculty may adapt prompts for different literacy levels or languages.
- Learners may include completed tools in a Workforce Readiness Portfolio for coaching or job-placement discussions.
- These resources model UDL principles by offering multiple means of engagement, representation, and expression.
- Collectively, they encourage learners to take ownership of their progress while connecting classroom practice to workforce readiness.

Faculty Note: Connecting Reflection and Student Tools

The student-centered tools in Appendix D complement the faculty reflection and fidelity materials in Appendix C by providing observable evidence of learner engagement, agency, and growth.

When instructors integrate these tools into their modules, completed learner worksheets and reflections can:

- Demonstrate the use of UDL-aligned practices (multiple means of engagement, representation, and expression).
- Provide authentic data for Program Fidelity Trackers and reflection logs - showing how inclusive strategies translate into learner outcomes.
- Support program review, accreditation, or grant reporting through concrete examples of inclusive, workforce-aligned instruction.
- Encourage shared reflection between learners and faculty, strengthening classroom relationships and modeling self-regulated learning.

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Appendix E - Lesson Template and Licensing Information

Resource Repository: Lesson Template and Licensing Information

Purpose

This appendix provides a single editable template that instructors can use to design new lessons following the *Toolkit for Inclusive Workforce Education* format. It also outlines licensing and future-use guidance to support open, equitable implementation.

It supports program consistency, reduces faculty preparation time, and ensures new lessons align with Universal Design for Learning (UDL) and Socially Just Disability Resources (SJDR) principles.

Lesson-Plan Shell (Editable Template)

(Modeled after Appendices B and C Modules)

Table E1 Lesson-Plan Shell (Editable Template)

Section	Prompt / Example
Module Title	Enter the lesson or skill area (e.g., “Professional Communication”).
Purpose / Learning Outcomes	State 2–3 measurable outcomes linked to workforce or academic skills.
Scenario Hook	Write a short real-world situation that connects to learner experience.
Direct Instruction	List resources (video, infographic, text) and describe how each support UDL representation.
Scaffolded Activities	Outline Model → Guide → Independent sequence, including timing or supports.
Reflection Prompts	Provide 2–3 reflection or discussion questions.
Assessment Options	Describe performance rubric or self-check criteria.
Instructor Notes	Add accessibility reminders, trauma-informed practices, or cultural examples.
Faculty Reflection	Space for post-lesson notes or fidelity check.
Delivery Mode	Indicate whether the lesson is In-Person, Online, or Hybrid.
Accessibility Check	Verify captions, alt-text, and readable format.

This table may be copied into Word, Canvas, or another LMS and completed digitally or in print.

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Future Adaptation and Continuous Improvement

Faculty are encouraged to adapt, expand, and share revised versions of these templates through professional-learning communities or curriculum committees. Additions such as new modules, visuals, or reflective prompts can enhance scalability and maintain alignment with *Vision 2030* priorities for equity, access, and workforce mobility (CCCCO, 2025). Sharing updates through communities strengthens collective capacity for inclusive workforce education.

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